

Figure 21.1 Crops cultivated according to utility

According to utility, crops are classified as below.

Food crops

Paddy and maize are cultivated for human consumption.

Fodder crops

These are useful for livestock consumption. E.g. Sorghum, millets

Fibre crops

These crops are used for cordage and textile. E.g. Cotton and hemp

Oil crops

Oil crops are useful in a large scale for consumption or industrial uses. E.g. Ground nut and sesame.

Ornamental crops

These are utilized for landscape gardening. E.g- Croton and Bougainvillea.

DO YOU KNOW?

Our country is the largest producer of bananas and mangoes in the world. It is also the second largest producer of wheat and rice.

Activity 1

Mention few examples for Kharif, Rabi and Zaid crops cultivated in your area.

Kharif	Rabi	Zaid

21.2 Basic Practices of Crop Production

Different activities in crop production are ploughing, sowing, applying fertilizers, harvesting and seed storage. All these activities collectively have an effect on the yield of crops.

21.2.1 Soil preparation

The most important aspect in agricultural process is to loosen the topsoil. The loosened soil helps in the growth of earthworm and soil microbes. These organisms add humus to the soil and are friendly to farmers. Plants absorb water, minerals, nutrients and air from the soil through their roots. Hence it is essential to prepare the soil in a proper way before starting the cultivation practice. The soil preparation methods are given below.

a. Ploughing

Ploughing or tilling is the process of loosening and turning the soil up and down to facilitate the availability of nutrients in the root zone of the cultivating crop.



Manual ploughing Machine ploughing

Figure 21.2 Ploughing

The following are the few important agricultural implements generally used in the field preparation.

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